

ORDINANCE NO. 512

AN ORDINANCE AMENDING ORDINANCE 359 AND 478 OF THE ZONING REGULATIONS OF THE CITY OF RECTOR TO REDUCE MINIMUM LOT AREA AND MODIFY DIMENSIONAL REQUIREMENTS IN R-1 AND R-2 RESIDENTIAL DISTRICTS, AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

WHEREAS, the Rector Planning Commission has studied and recommended amendments to dimensional requirements in the R-1 and R-2 Residential Zones to better reflect the size and layout of existing lots, reduce the number of nonconforming parcels, and support the construction of modest, site-built homes as an affordable housing alternative; and

WHEREAS, the City Council of Rector concurs with the Planning Commission's findings and finds that these amendments will promote housing opportunity, improve administrative efficiency, and align local zoning with the City's long-term development and infrastructure goals;

WHEREAS, a public hearing was posted and was held with the Planning Commission to allow public input, and

WHEREAS, the Planning Commission has made recommendations to the City Council for modification of the existing ordinance.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT ORDAINED BY THE CITY COUNCIL OF RECTOR, ARKANSAS:

Section 1. Purpose

The purpose of this ordinance is to modernize outdated residential lot size and dimensional requirements in the R-1 and R-2 districts, to reduce the number of nonconforming lots, and to support the construction of modest, site-built homes on more attainable lots. These changes reflect national zoning best practices and provide an affordable, permanent alternative to manufactured housing while preserving the existing neighborhood character.

Section 2. The City Council seeks to modify Ordinance 478 and Ordinance 359 Article 5-2 (C) – Medium Density Residential (R-1) to read as follows:

C. Area Requirements

1. Minimum Lot Area: 6,000 square feet.
2. Minimum Lot Width at Front Building Line:
 - a. Interior Lot: 60 feet.
 - b. Exterior Lot: 75 feet.
3. Minimum Lot Depth: 90 feet.
4. Front Yard Setback: Minimum of 15 feet from front property line.

5. Rear Yard Setback: Minimum of 10 feet from rear property line, or 27½ feet from centerline of alley, whichever is greater.
6. Side Yard Setback (interior lot): Minimum of 5 feet from each side property line.
7. Side Yard Setback (exterior lot): Minimum of 15 feet from street-side property line.
8. Height Regulations: Maximum height of residential structures shall not exceed 24 feet above average elevation.
9. Parking Regulations: Two off-street parking spaces shall be provided for each residence.
10. Accessory Buildings: No accessory building shall be erected on any required front yard. Side and rear yard setbacks shall be the same as for the principal structure. Accessory buildings shall be at least five (5) feet from all other buildings on the same lot and may not cover more than thirty (30) percent of the remaining rear yard area.
11. Freestanding Pre-Manufactured Carports:
 - a. Minimum side yard setback: 2 feet.
 - b. Front yard setback: Must comply with standard front yard requirement.
 - c. Rear yard setback: Minimum of 10 feet.

Section 3. The City Council seeks to modify Ordinance 359 and 478 Article 5-3 (C) – High Density Residential (R-2) to read as follows:

C. Area Requirements

1. Lot Area
 - a. 6,000 square feet for the first unit, plus 2,000 square feet for each additional unit, up to four units per structure.
2. Minimum Lot Width at Front Building Line:
 - a. One-family: 50 feet.
 - b. Two-family: 60 feet.
 - c. For each additional unit over two: Add 10 feet.
 - d. Exterior/corner lots shall be 15 feet wider than interior lots.
3. Minimum Lot Depth: 70 feet.
4. Front Yard Setback: Minimum of 15 feet from front property line.

5. Side Yard Setback (interior lot): Minimum of 5 feet from each side property line.
6. Side Yard Setback (exterior lot): Minimum of 15 feet from street-side property line.
7. Rear Yard Setback: Minimum of 10 feet from rear property line, or 27½ feet from centerline of alley, whichever is greater.
8. Height Regulations: Maximum height of a structure shall not exceed 24 feet above average elevation.
9. On-lot Parking:
 - a. One and two-family: Two spaces per unit.
 - b. Multi-family dwellings: Four spaces for first two units, plus one additional space for each added unit.
10. Accessory Buildings: Same as R-1.
11. Freestanding Pre-Manufactured Carports:
 - a. Minimum side yard setback: 2 feet.
 - b. Front yard setback: Must comply with standard front yard requirement.
 - c. Rear yard setback: Minimum of 10 feet.

Section 4. Severability

That the provisions of this Ordinance are separable and if a section, phrase or provision shall be declared invalid; such declaration shall not affect the validity of the remainder of the Ordinance.

Section 5.

That all ordinances and resolutions and parts thereof in conflict herewith are hereby repealed to the extent of such conflict.

EMERGENCY CLAUSE:

It is hereby found and declared that immediate changes to dimensional standards in residential zones are necessary to reduce barriers to housing development, support local builders, and ensure future grant-supported infrastructure improvements can serve future growth. Therefore, an emergency is declared to exist, and this ordinance shall be in full force and effect immediately upon its passage and publication.

PASSED AND APPROVED this 9th day of OCTOBER, 2025.

By: 
Mayor Shawn Brandon

Attested:


City Clerk